A relationship yes. But not a sordid affair.

I tried a new tack. *Everyone in this family has sued the press, including Granny. Why's this any different?*

Chirping crickets. Silence.

There was some more wrangling, and then I said:

We had no other option. And we wouldn't have had to do it if you'd all protected us. And protected the monarchy in the process. You're doing a disservice to yourselves by not protecting my wife.

I looked around the table. Stony faces. Was it incomprehension? Cognitive dissonance? A long-term mission at play? Or…did they really not know? Were they so deep inside a bubble inside a bubble that they really hadn't fully appreciated how bad things were?

For instance, *Tatler* magazine quoting an old Etonian saying I'd married Meg because "foreigners" like her are "easier" than girls "with the right background."

Or the *Daily Mail* saying Meg was "upwardly mobile," because she'd gone from "slaves to royalty" in just 150 years.

Or the social media posts about her being a "yacht girl" and an "escort," or calling her a "gold-digger," and "a whore," and "a bitch," and "a slut," and the N-word—repeatedly. Some of those posts were in the comments section on the pages of all three Palaces' social media accounts—and still hadn't been expunged.

Or the tweet that said: "Dear Duchess, I'm not saying that I hate you but I hope your next period happens in a shark tank."

Or the revelation of racist texts from Jo Marney, girlfriend of UKIP leader Henry Bolton, including one saying that my "black American" fiancée would "taint" the Royal Family, setting the stage for "a black king," and another averring that Ms. Marney would never have sex with "a Negro."

"This is Britain, not Africa."

Or the *Mail* complaining that Meg couldn't keep her hands off her baby bump, that she was rubbing it and rubbing it as if she were a succubus.

Things had got so out of hand, seventy-two women in Parliament, from both main parties, had condemned the "colonial undertones" of all newspaper coverage of The Duchess of Sussex.